CSRA MARKETING

2027 EDITION

The 2027 Roofing Website Buyer's Guide

What to pay, what to ask, and what to avoid before you hire anyone to build your website. Written for roofing company owners, in plain English, by someone who builds these sites for a living.

A free guide for roofing company owners

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> **A note on numbers in this guide**
>
> Every statistic in this guide comes from a named source. Where I walk through math with made-up-but-realistic numbers, I label it clearly as an illustrative example so you always know what is real data and what is a what-if.

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INTRODUCTION

Why most roofing websites fail

I want to be straight with you. Most roofing websites I look at are not doing their job. They look fine at first glance. Nice logo, a photo of a roof, a phone number somewhere. But they do not bring in jobs, and the owner has no idea why.

Here is the uncomfortable truth: your website has one job. It is not to look pretty. It is not to tell your company story. Its one job is to turn a homeowner with a leaking roof into a phone call or a quote request. Everything else is decoration.

I have reviewed hundreds of roofer websites over the years. The failures follow the same patterns. The site was built for desktop and never properly designed for a phone, even though most homeowners search from one. The phone number is buried in a menu instead of sitting at the top of every page as a big tappable button. The site lists "services" on one generic page instead of giving each service its own page that Google can actually rank. There is no quote form, or the form asks for twelve fields and nobody finishes it. The photos are stock images of houses that look nothing like the homes in your market. And the copy was written by someone who has never talked to a homeowner about a roof in their life.

None of this is the roofer's fault. You are a roofing expert, not a web expert. You hired someone who sounded confident, you paid real money, and you got a website that sits there like a billboard in the desert. This guide exists so that never happens to you again.

53%

of mobile visits are abandoned if a page takes longer than 3 seconds to load. Most of your customers are on a phone. Speed is not a technical detail, it is the difference between a call and a lost job.

Source: Google / SOASTA mobile page speed research, 2017

Whether you are building your first site or replacing one that is not working, this guide will tell you what to pay, what to ask, what to avoid, and how to know if the whole thing is actually working. No jargon. No sales pitch until the very last page, and even that is free.

Kemar

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CHAPTER 1

What your roofing website should include

Before we talk about price or platforms, let us get clear on what you are actually buying. A roofing website that brings in jobs has specific pages and specific features. If a proposal does not include most of what is below, ask why.

The pages every roofing site needs

Page	What it does
Homepage	Answers three questions in the first five seconds: what you do, where you do it, and how to contact you. Big phone number, big quote button, real photos of your work.
Service pages	One dedicated page per service: roof replacement, roof repair, storm damage, metal roofing, gutters, whatever you sell. Google ranks pages, not websites, so each service needs its own page to show up in search.
Service area pages	One page per town or city you serve. A homeowner in Evans searches "roofer in Evans," not "roofer." These pages are how you show up for the searches that actually turn into calls.
About page	Your story, your crew, your values. Homeowners are inviting you onto their roof and into their yard. They want to know who you are before they call.
Reviews page	Your best reviews, pulled together in one place, with links out to your Google profile. Reviews are trust at scale.
Contact / quote page	A short quote form plus your phone number, hours, and service area. This is the page where a visitor becomes a lead, so it has to be dead simple.

Why service area pages matter so much

Think with Google reports that 76% of people who search on their smartphone for something nearby visit a business within a day. Those searches include the town name. If you serve eight towns but your site only mentions your home city, you are invisible for most of the searches that would bring you work.

The features that turn visitors into calls

- ✓ **Click-to-call button on mobile.** On a phone, your number should be a big tappable button, visible without scrolling. Most roof shoppers are on a phone, standing in their driveway looking at a leak.

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- ✓ **A short quote form.** Name, phone, address, and what they need. That is it. Every extra field you add costs you leads. (HubSpot's research on form friction has shown for years that fewer fields consistently convert better.)
- ✓ **Trust signals above the fold.** Review stars, years in business, license info, manufacturer certifications. A homeowner decides in seconds whether you look legitimate.
- ✓ **Real photos, not stock.** Your crew, your trucks, your actual roofs. Stock photos of perfect houses erode trust the moment a homeowner notices, and they notice.
- ✓ **Fast load times.** Every second of delay loses visitors. That 53% abandonment stat from the introduction applies directly to your quote page.
- ✓ **Mobile-first design.** Designed for the phone first, then adapted for desktop. Not the other way around.
- ✓ **Clear service area.** A list or map of the towns you serve, so nobody wastes your time (or theirs) calling from outside your area.

> **The one-question test**
>
> Pull up your current site on your phone. Can a stranger tell what you do, where you do it, and how to call you within five seconds? If not, the site is failing its one job, no matter how nice it looks.

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CHAPTER 2

How much a roofing website should cost

This is the question every roofer asks and almost nobody answers honestly. So here are the real market ranges, what drives the price up or down, and why the cheapest option usually ends up being the most expensive.

Honest price ranges

Route	Typical range	Who it fits
DIY website builder	$20 to $60 per month, plus many hours of your time	Brand-new companies testing the waters with almost no budget. You do everything: design, copy, photos, setup.
Freelancer	$1,000 to $5,000 one-time	Small companies that need a real site but cannot fund an agency build. Quality varies wildly, so vet carefully (see Chapters 4 and 5).
Web design agency	$5,000 to $15,000+ one-time	Established companies that want professional copywriting, real local SEO foundations, and a site built to convert from day one.

Those are one-time build costs. Most sites also carry ongoing costs: hosting, domain renewal, security updates, and content changes. Budget a few hundred dollars a year at minimum, more if you want someone handling updates for you.

What drives the price up

- **Number of pages.** A 6-page brochure site and a 40-page site with a page per service per town are different projects with different prices.
- **Copywriting.** Professional copy written for homeowners costs more than a template with lorem ipsum you fill in yourself. It also converts dramatically better.
- **Photography and video.** A shoot of your real crew and real jobs costs money and is worth it. Stock photos are free and worth exactly that.
- **Custom features.** Quote calculators, financing applications, CRM integrations, and online scheduling all add cost because they add build time and testing.
- **SEO foundations.** Proper page structure, local schema, speed optimization, and Google Business Profile alignment take real expertise. A site without them is cheaper and nearly invisible.

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What is overpriced, and what is underpriced

Overpriced looks like this: a premium price tag on a recycled template with stock photos, filler copy you are expected to rewrite, and no SEO setup. You are paying custom prices for assembly-line work. The red flags in Chapter 4 will help you spot this.

Underpriced looks like a $500 site from someone who disappears after launch. Here is why cheap sites cost more in the long run: they generate few or no leads, so you pay for a rebuild within a year or two; they load slowly and look dated, which actively sends jobs to competitors; and every month they underperform is a month of lost revenue you never get back.

> **Do the math on one job (illustrative example)**
>
> Take a typical residential roof at $12,000 with a 40% margin. That is $4,800 in gross profit from a single job. If a well-built site brings you just one extra job per month, that is $57,600 in gross profit per year. Even two extra jobs per year covers most professional builds. A website is not an expense to minimize. It is a salesperson that works 24 hours a day, and you should judge its price against the jobs it brings in, not against the cheapest quote you can find.

The bottom line on budget

Spend what your business stage justifies, but spend it on the right things: conversion-focused pages, real copy, real photos, and SEO foundations. A $3,000 site built to convert will outperform a $10,000 site built to look pretty every single time. Price is what you pay. Jobs are what you get. Judge every quote by the second one.

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CHAPTER 3

WordPress vs. custom: an honest breakdown

Sooner or later someone will ask you which platform you want. Here is what the two main options actually mean for a roofing company, without the sales spin from either side.

WordPress: the popular choice

WordPress powers a huge share of all websites on the internet, including plenty of contractor sites. It is an open platform with thousands of pre-built designs and add-ons, which is why so many freelancers and agencies build on it.

Pros	Cons	What it means for you
Flexible and widely supported; almost any web person can work on it	Needs regular updates for security and features; neglected sites get hacked or break	You will either learn basic maintenance or pay someone to handle it
Easy to add features later (forms, galleries, scheduling)	Can get bloated and slow if loaded with too many add-ons	Ask your builder to keep it lean; speed matters more than widgets
You can edit text and photos yourself without coding	Popular platform means it is a common target for attacks	Backups and security updates are non-negotiable, not optional
Lower build cost in most cases	Design quality depends entirely on who builds it	A bad WordPress site and a good one have nothing in common but the name

Custom-built: the tailored option

A custom site is coded specifically for your business, without a pre-built platform underneath. Fewer roofers go this route, but it has real advantages.

Pros	Cons	What it means for you
Typically very fast, because there is no extra bulk	Usually higher upfront cost	Makes sense when speed and performance are top priorities

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No update treadmill; nothing to patch every month	Harder to edit yourself; you depend on the builder for changes	Clarify who makes updates and what they charge before you sign
Harder to hack; smaller attack surface	Smaller pool of people who can maintain it if the builder disappears	Get full ownership of the code in writing (see Chapter 5, question 1)
Exactly what you need, nothing you do not	New features take longer to add than on a flexible platform	Great if your needs are stable; less great if you experiment constantly

Who each one is for

- **WordPress fits most roofing companies.** If you want to update your own content, add features over time, and keep build costs reasonable, it is the practical default. Just make sure someone is maintaining it.
- **Custom fits companies that prioritize speed and simplicity.** If you want the fastest possible site, minimal maintenance, and a builder you trust long-term, custom is worth the premium.

> **The maintenance question nobody asks**
>
> Every website needs maintenance. WordPress needs updates, backups, and security checks. Custom sites need a developer on call for changes. The platform matters less than the answer to this question: who maintains the site after launch, and what does it cost? Get that answer in writing before you pay a deposit. A site with no maintenance plan is a site with an expiration date.

One more thing: do not let anyone sell you on a platform because of what is trendy. The platform does not bring you jobs. Fast pages, clear calls to action, and content Google can rank bring you jobs. Pick the platform your builder does best, then hold them to the standards in Chapter 1.

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CHAPTER 4

Red flags in web design proposals

A proposal tells you everything about how a project will go. These are the warning signs I tell every roofer to watch for. One flag is a question to ask. Three or more is a reason to walk away.

1. Vague deliverables. "A modern, professional website" is not a deliverable. A real proposal lists exact pages, features, and what is included with each. If you cannot tell what you are buying, you cannot tell if you got it.

2. No timeline or milestones. A proposal with no start date, no draft review date, and no launch date is a project that will drift for months. Professionals commit to dates in writing.

3. You do not own the site. This is the big one. Some builders register your domain in their name, host the site on their private server, and hold everything hostage if you try to leave. You should own your domain, your content, and your site files outright. If the proposal is unclear on ownership, assume the worst.

4. No copywriting included. Many cheap proposals expect you to write all the text. You are a roofer, not a copywriter, and blank pages stall projects for months. Ask exactly who writes what.

5. No mobile-specific design. If the proposal talks about how the site looks on desktop and says nothing about phones, run. Your customers are on phones. A desktop-first build in 2027 is malpractice.

6. A template sold as custom. Templates are fine at template prices. What is not fine is paying custom prices for a recycled design with your logo dropped in. Ask directly: is this built from scratch or from a template? There is no shame in either answer, only in hiding it.

7. No analytics access. If you cannot see your own traffic, calls, and form submissions, you cannot know if the site works. You should have full access to your own data from day one. "We will send you reports" is not a substitute.

8. Hidden recurring fees. Watch for vague monthly charges for "hosting and maintenance" with no breakdown. Legitimate ongoing costs are itemized. Mystery fees are a revenue stream for them, not a service for you.

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9. Zero contractor or home-service work in the portfolio. A beautiful restaurant website proves nothing about selling roofs. Roofing buyers behave differently from restaurant diners. Your builder should have proof they understand your customer.

10. Guaranteed #1 Google rankings. Nobody can guarantee rankings. Google says so itself. A guarantee of the top spot is either a lie or a trick (ranking #1 for a search term nobody types). Honest builders talk about realistic timelines and measurable leading indicators, not guarantees.

The gut-check rule

If a proposal is hard to understand, that is not an accident. Confusing proposals protect the seller, not the buyer. A good proposal reads like a plain-English list: here is what you get, here is when, here is what it costs, and here is what happens after launch. If you need a translator, find another builder.

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CHAPTER 5

10 questions to ask before you hire anyone

Take these to every sales call. The questions matter, but the real value is in how the answers are given. Confident, specific answers mean a professional. Dodging and vagueness mean you are about to have a bad experience.

1. Do I own the website, the domain, and all content outright?

Why it matters: This is the most important question on the list. If the builder owns your domain or holds your site on their private server, you cannot leave without starting over. Ownership should be in the contract, in plain language, before you pay anything.

2. What exactly is included in the price?

Why it matters: Get an itemized list: pages, features, copywriting, photography, revisions, launch checklist. "Everything you need" is not an answer. Surprises after the deposit are how $3,000 projects become $6,000 projects.

3. Who writes the copy?

Why it matters: Copy is what sells the job. If the answer is "you do," add weeks to your timeline and expect a site full of placeholder text. If they write it, ask to see samples written for contractors, not just generic businesses.

4. What is the timeline, and what happens if it slips?

Why it matters: You need a start date, a date you review the draft, and a launch date. Ask what happens on each side if deadlines slip, including what they need from you and by when. Shared accountability keeps projects moving.

5. How many revision rounds are included?

Why it matters: You will want changes. Everyone does. Know upfront how many rounds of changes are included and what extra rounds cost. One round is tight. Two is standard. Unlimited usually means the price is padded somewhere else.

6. Will the site be designed mobile-first?

Why it matters: Most of your traffic comes from phones. "Mobile-friendly" can mean a desktop site squeezed onto a small screen. "Mobile-first" means the phone experience was designed first, on purpose. Ask to see the mobile designs before anything is built.

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7. How do I update content after launch, and what does that cost?

Why it matters: You will want to change phone numbers, add photos, update service areas. Find out whether you can do it yourself, whether you need them, and what each path costs. A site you cannot afford to update becomes outdated within a year.

8. How will we measure whether the site is working?

Why it matters: If they talk about traffic and rankings but not calls and quote requests, they are measuring the wrong thing. You want call tracking, form notifications, and a simple monthly count of real leads. Chapter 6 covers exactly what to track.

9. What happens if we part ways?

Why it matters: Ask about the exit before you enter. How do you get your files, your domain, and your content? Is there a handover fee? A professional has a clean, boring answer. An awkward silence tells you everything.

10. Can I talk to two roofing or contractor clients you built for?

Why it matters: References from your industry beat a pretty portfolio every time. Ask those owners three things: did it launch on time, did it bring in leads, and would you hire them again? If a builder cannot produce two happy contractor clients, keep looking.

How to use these on a sales call

Do not email the list ahead of time. Ask live and listen. The best builders welcome these questions because they already have good answers. The ones who get defensive were hoping you would never ask.

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CHAPTER 6

How to measure if your site is working

Your website is a salesperson. You would never keep a salesperson you could not measure, so do not do it with your site. Here is the simple system I recommend to every roofer.

Track calls and form fills, not traffic

Traffic is a vanity number. A thousand visitors who never call are worth less than fifty visitors who request three quotes. The only numbers that matter:

- ✓ **Phone calls from the site.** Use a tracked number or call button tracking so you know which calls came from the website versus referrals or yard signs.
- ✓ **Quote form submissions.** Every form fill should hit your email or phone instantly, with the page it came from attached so you know what the homeowner was looking at.
- ✓ **Booked jobs.** Once a month, match your new jobs against the calls and forms. This is your true close rate from website leads, and it is the number that decides whether the site pays for itself.

Simple benchmarks (illustrative examples)

Every market is different, but these ranges give you a starting point. Treat them as rough guides, not guarantees:

Metric	Healthy range	What it tells you
Visitor-to-lead conversion	2% to 5% of visitors become a call or form fill	Below 2%, your pages are not convincing visitors to act. For context, HubSpot's long-running benchmarks put average landing page conversion around 2% to 3%, with top performers well above that.
Mobile load time	Under 3 seconds	Slower than this and you are losing more than half your mobile visitors before they see anything (Google / SOASTA, 2017).
Lead-to-job close rate	20% to 40% depending on your sales process	If leads come in but jobs do not, the problem is follow-up speed and sales process, not the website.

Put a dollar value on it (illustrative example)

Say your site brings 10 leads a month and you close 30% of them. That is 3 jobs. At $12,000 per roof with a 40% margin, each job is $4,800 in gross profit, so 3 jobs is $14,400 per month in gross

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> profit from the site. Now you know exactly what the site is worth to you, and exactly what you can afford to invest in improving it.

What to ignore

- **Raw traffic.** Up, down, sideways, it means nothing without conversions attached.
- **Bounce rate alone.** A visitor who calls you within 30 seconds "bounced." That is a win, not a problem.
- **Keyword rankings in isolation.** Ranking #1 for a term nobody searches is a trophy nobody sees. Rankings matter only when they produce calls.

Review quarterly, not daily

Check your call and form counts once a month. Do a deeper review once a quarter: which pages produce leads, which service area pages are dead, what are callers asking about. Small, steady improvements beat a redesign every two years. A website is not a project you finish. It is an asset you tune.

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Your next step

You now know more about buying a roofing website than most of the people selling them. If you want a second set of eyes before you sign anything, or before you spend another dollar on a site that is not working, I will personally review your website for free.

- ✓ What is helping you win jobs right now
- ✓ What is quietly costing you calls every week
- ✓ The three highest-impact fixes, in plain English

No pitch, no pressure, no pricing talk. Just an honest audit from someone who builds roofing websites for a living.

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